

Teacher Manual — M/J Civics

Facilitator copy. Contains answer guides, rubrics, grading thresholds, and sensitive-content scripts.

Do not publish this document to students. It documents the course as built: five numbered modules (Weeks 1–18) plus a sixth Supplemental Standards-Coverage module, two cumulative Quarterly Exams, eighteen numbered lessons, primary-source and extension assignments, and VR activities — and, new in this revision, the Florida Civics EOC standards index in Section 11. Keep it in your teacher files and re-render it if the course is revised.

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SECTION

0 How to use this manual

This is the facilitator guide for M/J Civics. It assumes you already have access to the built Canvas course and its linked lesson pages. Read Sections 1, 2, and 5 before your first week; keep Sections 6, 7, and 11 open while you grade; and use Sections 9 and 14 to plan your weekly rhythm. Everything here is drawn from the course as it actually exists. Anything that depends on your school's current Canvas configuration is marked **[VERIFY]**.

SECTION

1 How this course works — typical lesson, typical week, major assessments

A typical lesson page. Lessons live on Optima-hosted pages linked from each Canvas module (for example, .../mjcivics-lessons/weeks/week-01/lesson-1-1.html). Walking Lesson 1.1 top to bottom shows the pattern every lesson follows: a header and framing question (the Optima owl, a small metadata grid, and a single opening question that frames the lesson — here, “What does it actually take for ordinary citizens to rule themselves?”); three “I will be able to...” objectives; an ungraded Quick Check-In self-reflection; two or three

content blocks with a “Helpful to Know” call-out clearing up a likely misconception; a Subject Vocabulary glossary box at the top and, where the lesson introduces a foreign-language or non-English term, a Foreign Language Vocabulary box inline near its first use; one embedded Try It widget with immediate feedback and no submission; and a closing “Carry This Forward” synthesis box naming the throughline into the next lesson.

The graded touchpoints are not on the lesson page itself. They are the separate Canvas items that follow it in the module: the Reading Quiz, the linked Primary Source, and the written assignment (Critical Questions or a Primary Source Report/Exercise).

A typical week. One numbered lesson (with two parts, X.1 and X.2) fills a week. The module's week range tells you the pace:

Module	Weeks	Lessons
1 · Greco-Roman Foundations	1–2	1.1–2.2
2 · Enlightenment & Founding Documents	3–8	3.1–8.2
3 · Constitutional Structure	9–11 (Quarter 1 Exam right after Wk 9)	9.1–11.2
4 · Civil Liberties & Rights	12–15	12.1–15.2
5 · Civic Participation, Foreign Policy & Comparative Government	16–18 + Quarter 2 Exam	16.1–18.2
6 · Supplemental Standards-Coverage	n/a — standalone	2 assignments (Gap-Fill 10, Gap-Fill 14)

Segment	What the student does	Graded?	Tier
Intro wrapper (first week of a module only)	Answers the module's essential question cold; rates confidence	Completion (survey)	4
Lesson X.1	Reads the interactive lesson page; does the Quick Check-In and Try It widget	No (ungraded practice)	1
Reading Quiz X.1	5 auto-graded multiple-choice inference questions on the lesson	Auto	1
Primary Source 1	Reads the assigned primary text (with translation/context notes)	No	1
Critical Questions X.1	Writes two short reasoned answers arguing from the source	Teacher-graded	2
Lesson X.2 + Primary Source 2	Second half of the week's topic and its source	No	1
Primary Source Report / Exercise X	Written analysis of the second source (two questions)	Teacher-graded	2 or 3
VR X-A / X-B	Immersive activity tied to the week's content; produces a capture or short response	Completion / light	2

Extension (Weeks 5–11)	Standards-gap primary-source assignment	Teacher-graded	2
Outro wrapper (last week of a module only)	Re-answers the essential question; rates confidence; notes what is still unclear	Completion (survey)	4
Quarterly Exam (right after Week 9, end of Module 5)	30–31 cumulative multiple-choice questions covering the quarter	Auto	Milestone

Major assessments. This course now has two cumulative Quarterly Exams — a 30-question Quarter 1 Exam (Weeks 1–9) sitting inside Module 3, right after Week 9's content and before Week 10 begins (not at the Module 3/Module 4 boundary — Module 3 continues for two more weeks, covering the Executive and Judicial branches, after the exam), and a 31-question Quarter 2 Exam (Weeks 10–18) genuinely sitting at the end of Module 5, both auto-graded multiple-choice and both in the Projects & Milestones group. Outside of those two milestones, the course's rigor is still distributed across recurring, teacher-graded, source-based writing. The teacher-graded items per module are what drive your workload (see Section 10); the two exams add zero grading time.

SECTION

2 Ungraded interactives & the intro/outro wrappers

Two things new facilitators most often misread:

- **The ungraded interactives cost you nothing.** The Quick Check-Ins, “Helpful to Know” boxes, Try It widgets, vocabulary glossaries, and “Carry This Forward” syntheses on the lesson pages give students immediate feedback and never produce a submission. They are formation by practice, not busywork to chase. A student who skips them will show it indirectly — in a weaker Reading Quiz or a thinner Critical Questions answer — not as a missing grade. Do not build a gradebook column for them.
- **The wrappers are Canvas Quizzes in survey mode, not pages.** Each module opens with an Intro Wrapper and closes with an Outro Wrapper (Module 5's is the Course Closing Reflection). They capture the essential-question answer (first and refined), a confidence rating, and “what's still unclear” as sortable cohort data — that is the whole point of making them quizzes.

The single highest-leverage move in the course. Spend 15–20 minutes reading each module's Outro Wrapper responses as a set. Sort for low-confidence clusters and repeated “still unclear” concepts. Then act: post one targeted announcement addressing the top confusion, and message the two or three students whose confidence dropped. This finds struggling students weeks before a grade would.

SECTION

3 AI & VR in this course (student-facing)

AI. The course posture, stated in the syllabus and consistent across Optima, is AI awareness, not required tool use. Students may use AI to support their learning (explain a concept another way, check understanding, brainstorm) unless an assignment says otherwise, but AI may never do the reasoning an assignment asks for — and the source-based Critical Questions and Primary Source Reports specifically ask for the student's own

reasoning from a text. If a student uses AI, they note it briefly. Do not add new AI requirements; speak to it as judgment students are building, not a tool they must adopt.

VR. Each numbered lesson carries one or two VR activities (for example, Walking the Athenian Agora, The Convention Floor, The Supreme Court Bench, Two Systems, Side by Side). Students enter the space tied to the week's content, do a short guided task, and produce a capture or brief written response. Where a solo activity offers a choice of location or vantage point, the default is the student's choice. Review captures as a set and, when useful, assemble a short gallery walk so the cohort sees several students' work. Describe VR by what students do; the platform is being updated, so avoid naming a specific one. Five weeks (2, 6, 16, 17, 18) also carry a graded VR Sync Activity in the Synchronous Homework & Activities group, on top of the two standard solo activities every week gets.

SECTION

4 Using Ignite AI to support students (teacher-facing)

[VERIFY] before relying on specifics — Ignite AI's exact features and availability vary by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled. Confirm the current feature set in your instance; the moves below are described functionally so they hold regardless of the exact buttons.

The teacher's Canvas AI assistant is a support tool for you, and it is the main lever that makes a high student-to-teacher ratio feel personal. Use it to:

- Draft individualized feedback on Critical Questions and Primary Source Reports, which you then edit and own. Faster turnaround, same human judgment.
- Summarize a module's Outro Wrapper responses to surface the cohort's sticking points in minutes rather than by hand.
- Surface students who need a nudge — low outro confidence, missed work, a declining quiz trend — and draft a warm check-in message.
- Generate practice variants for a student who needs another rep on a reading-quiz skill (e.g., another chronological-order or inference item).
- Communicate with families in clear, kind summaries, and translate messages when that helps.

Govern every use by two rules: coach, not catch (Section 8), and AI drafts, the teacher decides. You read, edit, and own anything sent to a student or family. AI is never used to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize.

SECTION

5 Grading categories & Canvas gradebook setup

The course exports with three weighted assignment groups. Weights are percentage-based; confirm they imported intact.

Weight	Group	What's in it
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60%	Async Homework	Reading Quizzes (Tier 1), Critical Questions (Tier 2), Primary Source Exercises (Tier 2, in “Reading Quiz” weeks), Extension & Supplemental Assignments (Tier 2), and the two solo VR activities every week
30%	Projects & Milestones	Primary Source Reports (Tier 3, in “Primary Source Report” weeks only) and the two cumulative Quarterly Exams
10%	Synchronous Homework & Activities	Graded VR Sync Activities (Weeks 2, 6, 16, 17, 18) and any live-session work

Common mix-up worth flagging: Primary Source *Reports* (Tier 3, the weeks the course map marks “Primary Source Report”) sit in **Projects & Milestones**, not Async Homework — only Primary Source *Exercises* (Tier 2, the “Reading Quiz” weeks) are Async Homework. The two names look similar in the gradebook; check the group column, not just the name, before assuming.

Recommendation, not an enforced Canvas weight: the two Quarterly Exams share the Projects & Milestones group with the Primary Source Reports, so together the two exams default to roughly 30% of the course grade alongside that quarter's Reports — this is a recommended starting point, not a fixed split the course imposes. If you run a **Live** section and want the exams to count for more or less than that default (for example, to weight the cumulative exams more heavily than the individual Reports within the same 30% group), that's a per-section judgment call: adjust it in your own section's gradebook rather than the shared assignment-group weight, so you don't change the split for every other section on this master course.

1. Gradebook > Settings > Weight final grade based on assignment groups. Confirm the three groups above and their weights (60 / 30 / 10).
2. Set each item into the right group. Reading Quizzes, Critical Questions, Primary Source Exercises, and Extension/Supplemental Assignments → Async Homework. Primary Source Reports and the two Quarterly Exams → Projects & Milestones. VR Sync Activities and any live work → Synchronous Homework & Activities.
3. Mark both wrappers and the Course Closing Reflection as survey / completion (no assignment-group, zero points), so they gather data without distorting grades or needing a group assignment at all.

Completion vs. points. Use Modules > Requirements / progress view as your at-a-glance signal that ungraded scaffolding (lesson pages, wrappers, VR) is getting done. It shows movement without adding gradebook columns.

SECTION

6 Rubrics & answer guides for teacher-graded items

Use one rubric across every source-based writing assignment so grading stays consistent and fast (~5 min/student). Paste it as a native Canvas Rubric.

Criterion	Full (100%)	Developing (75%)	Emerging (50%)	Insufficient (0–25%)
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Understanding of the source	Reads the text accurately; grasps its claim in context	Mostly accurate; a minor misreading	Partial or surface reading	Misreads or ignores the source
Quality of reasoning	Argues from the text; addresses the actual question, including counterfactuals	Reasonable but thin; some restating	Mostly restates the source	No argument; unsupported opinion
Clarity & precision	Clear, organized, precise word choice	Understandable; some looseness	Hard to follow in places	Unclear or off-topic
Intellectual honesty	Own words; cites the text; flags any AI use	Own work; light sourcing	Over-relies on quotation	Not the student's own thinking

Each criterion is worth an equal share of the item's points. The bar is reasoning from the text, not information recall — every Critical Questions and Primary Source item now carries exactly two questions (question type varied, not labeled), written to defeat a student who only restates.

Answer guides — teacher only, never shown to students. The free-response prompts have textual right answers. Look for the idea, not the wording.

Critical Questions 1.1 (Aristotle, Constitution of the Athenians 21): the strongest answer argues Cleisthenes extended citizenship itself to people previously excluded (new residents outside the four old tribes), not merely the vote to citizens who lacked it — and uses the deme-name detail as evidence that old family/tribal identity was being deliberately overridden. Full credit requires distinguishing “extending the franchise” from “extending membership,” the central conceptual move. The counterfactual (keeping the four tribes) should conclude that outsiders would not have gained citizenship, because the reform's mechanism was the tribal reorganization itself.

Critical Questions / Primary Source items generally: full credit = a claim + specific textual evidence + reasoning that goes beyond paraphrase. Partial = correct claim but only paraphrase, or evidence without reasoning. None = restates the prompt, answers a different question, or opinion with no text. Landmark-case items (Module 4) should name the holding and the constitutional principle, not just the facts.

SECTION

7 Assessment & activity catalog — how to run and grade each type

Set your late/missing policy to match the syllabus: no penalty for an individual missed due date, zero for anything not done by quarter's end, 10% off in the final 14 days of a quarter. Attach the Section 6 rubric to every Critical Questions, Primary Source, and Extension item as a native Canvas Rubric so it scores in SpeedGrader.

Type	Scoring	Recommended move
Reading Quiz (Tier 1)	Auto-graded MC, 5 items; one attempt, correct answers shown	Leave to auto-grade. Scan the item-analysis for a question the whole cohort missed — that is your next announcement, not a regrade.

Critical Questions (Tier 2)	Teacher-graded free response, two questions, rubric above	Grade in a batch per lesson. Draft feedback with Ignite AI, edit, and lead with what the student did well.
Primary Source Report (Tier 3) / Exercise (Tier 2)	Teacher-graded, same rubric, two questions	Same batch pass as Critical Questions; cross-reference §6.
Extension / Supplemental Assignment (Tier 2)	Teacher-graded, same rubric, two questions	These carry specific standards (see §11). Grade them when a student's gradebook shows a gap in that benchmark.
Quarterly Exam (Milestone)	Auto-graded MC, 30 (Q1) or 31 (Q2) items; one attempt, 45-minute limit	Leave to auto-grade. Review the item analysis by EOC Reporting Category (§11) to spot systemic gaps before the real Florida EOC.
Intro / Outro Wrapper (Tier 4)	Survey / completion	Do not score for correctness. Read the outro as a set (§2).
VR activity (Tier 2 solo, Synchronous when a Sync Activity)	Completion / light; capture or short response	Check the capture happened; assemble an occasional gallery walk. Don't over-grade.
Try It widgets / self-checks	Ungraded	Nothing to do; formative only.

SECTION

8 Coach, not catch

Your job is to move each student forward, not to detect and punish. In practice:

- Feedback names the next step, not only the error; lead with what is working.
- Let students re-attempt Tier 1 practice — it is a learning tool, not a trap.
- Use analytics and Ignite AI to find students who need help early, then reach out. Not to build a case.
- On suspected AI misuse or copied answers, open a conversation: ask the student to talk through their reasoning from the text. Treat it as formation, not an accusation.
- Public comments model good thinking; they never single out weak work for criticism.

SECTION

9 Weekly announcement scripts

Because On-Demand students are asynchronous, your weekly announcement is your main presence. Clone this template, then use the per-module openers.

[Module / Week N] template. “Scholars — this week you should be in [Module N, Lesson X]. The focus is [one-line focus]. Don't miss: [the due Critical Questions / Primary Source Report, with date]. One tip: [the concept students trip on]. Questions? Office hours are [day/time], or message me any time. — [You]”

- **Module 1:** We begin where self-government began — Athens and Rome. Read Aristotle and Cicero slowly; the Critical Questions want you to argue from them, not summarize them.
- **Module 2 (six weeks):** The longest stretch of the course. We move from Locke and Hobbes to the Declaration and the Constitution. Pace one lesson a week and you will finish comfortably; the extension pieces (Magna Carta, Federalist 39) are where the big ideas connect.
- **Module 3:** This is the “how the machine is built” module — the three branches and their powers. Keep the Constitution open in another tab as you read. The Quarter 1 Exam comes right after Week 9, before you move into the Executive and Judicial branches — remind students it's cumulative back to Week 1.
- **Module 4:** Rights become real in court. We read the landmark cases themselves. Some are heavy (see below); reach out if anything sits uneasily.
- **Module 5:** We end wide — participation, foreign policy, and life in systems without liberty. The Quarter 2 Exam comes right after Week 18, before the Closing Reflection asks you to answer, in your own voice, the question we opened with in Week 1.

Situational scripts.

- *Mid-module check-in:* “If your confidence was low on the last wrapper, that's useful information, not a verdict. Here's a two-minute reset on [concept], and my hours are [day/time].”
- *Pre-assessment:* “Before you write [item], reread the source once more and underline the one line your argument will lean on.”
- *Re-engagement:* “I haven't seen work from you in a bit and I'd like to. Tell me where you're stuck — we'll make a plan.”

SECTION

10 Teacher workflow & workload map

A normal week, in order: triage the outro analytics (module boundaries only) → batch-grade the week's Critical Questions and Primary Source item → skim VR captures → post the weekly announcement → answer messages. Tier 1 auto-grades (near oh); the Quarterly Exams also auto-grade (near oh, one per quarter); Tier 2 is light; the Tier 3 Primary Source Reports are the real load and are best done in one batch per lesson.

Where the heavy weeks are: the load tracks the number of teacher-graded pieces per module. Module 2 is the peak — six lessons plus five extension assignments over six weeks. Module 3 is dense with extensions. Plan extra grading time on both. Module 6 (Supplemental) is the lightest possible load — just two standalone assignments for the whole course, assign whenever convenient in your pacing calendar.

Module	Relative facilitator-grading load
1 · Greco-Roman Foundations	Light
2 · Enlightenment & Founding Documents	Heavy (peak)
3 · Constitutional Structure	Moderate-heavy (extensions + Q1 Exam, auto-graded)

4 · Civil Liberties & Rights	Moderate
5 · Civic Participation, Foreign Policy & Comparative Government	Moderate (+ Q2 Exam, auto-graded)
6 · Supplemental Standards-Coverage	Minimal (2 items, whole course)

SECTION

11 Standards coverage & the Florida Civics EOC index

This course is aligned to Florida's SS.7.CG Civics & Government benchmarks. Standard codes are read from the built assessments and assignments; keep them in this teacher copy only, never on student pages.

Every one of the 40 SS.7.CG benchmarks has a home in this build — in a main week, a week Extension, or the Module 6 Supplemental assignments. Florida's Civics End-of-Course Assessment tests **39 of those 40**. The authoritative source is Appendix B (“Content Assessed by Civics End-of-Course Assessment”) in the Civics EOC Assessment Test Item Specifications (FLDOE, November 2023 draft). Appendix B organizes tested benchmarks under four Reporting Categories, matched below to where each is actually taught in this course. **SS.7.CG.4.4** (the significance of September 11, 2001) is the sole benchmark with no Appendix B entry at all — it remains valid course content (Module 6's Gap-Fill 14) but carries no EOC-alignment weight. Three benchmarks — **SS.7.CG.1.1**, **SS.7.CG.1.4**, and **SS.7.CG.3.14** — are EOC-tested but “Assessed by” a different benchmark's items (1.1/1.4 by 1.2; 3.14 by 2.6) rather than getting independent test items; they still count as EOC-tested content.

REPORTING CATEGORY 1: ORIGINS AND PURPOSES OF LAW AND GOVERNMENT (11 BENCHMARKS)

Benchmark	What it covers	Where taught
SS.7.CG.1.1	Influence of ancient Greece, Rome, Judeo-Christian tradition	Weeks 1–2
SS.7.CG.1.2	Principles underlying America's founding ideas on law and government	Week 3
SS.7.CG.1.3	Magna Carta, Mayflower Compact, English Bill of Rights, Common Sense	Extension, Week 5
SS.7.CG.1.4	Enlightenment ideas: Montesquieu's separation of powers, Locke's natural law/social contract	Weeks 3–4
SS.7.CG.1.5	British policies and colonial responses leading to the Declaration	Week 5
SS.7.CG.1.6	Ideas and grievances in the Declaration of Independence	Week 5
SS.7.CG.1.7	Weaknesses of the Articles of Confederation	Weeks 5–6
SS.7.CG.1.8	Purpose of the Preamble to the U.S. Constitution	Week 6
SS.7.CG.1.9	Separation of powers, checks and balances, rule of law, due process	Weeks 1–2, 7, 9
SS.7.CG.1.10	Federalists vs. Anti-Federalists on ratification	Weeks 7–8

SS.7.CG.1.11	The rule of law	Extension, Week 9
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REPORTING CATEGORY 2: ROLES, RIGHTS, AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF CITIZENS (10 BENCHMARKS)

Benchmark	What it covers	Where taught
SS.7.CG.2.1	Citizenship and the naturalization process	Extension, Week 10
SS.7.CG.2.2	Obligations vs. responsibilities of citizenship	Week 16
SS.7.CG.2.3	Rights in the Bill of Rights and other amendments	Week 12
SS.7.CG.2.4	How the Constitution and Bill of Rights safeguard individual rights	Weeks 12–13
SS.7.CG.2.5	Trial process and the role of juries	Weeks 14, 16
SS.7.CG.2.6	Elections and voting at local/state/national levels	Week 16
SS.7.CG.2.7	Constitutional qualifications to hold office	Extension, Week 10
SS.7.CG.2.8	Impact of media, individuals, and interest groups on government	Extension, Week 11
SS.7.CG.2.9	Bias, symbolism, and propaganda in media/political communication	Extension, Week 11
SS.7.CG.2.10	Civic problem-solving process (<i>enrichment only in Q1; formally assessed on the Q2 Exam</i>)	Extension, Week 5

REPORTING CATEGORY 3: GOVERNMENT POLICIES AND POLITICAL PROCESSES (15 BENCHMARKS)

Benchmark	What it covers	Where taught
SS.7.CG.3.1	Advantages of a constitutional republic over other forms of government	Weeks 2, 7–8
SS.7.CG.3.2	Advantages of a federal system of government	Extension, Week 7
SS.7.CG.3.3	Structure and function of the three branches	Weeks 4, 8, 10
SS.7.CG.3.4	Article IV and the 10th Amendment (state/national relationship)	Extension, Week 9
SS.7.CG.3.5	The Article V amendment process	Extension, Week 9
SS.7.CG.3.6	Amendments that broadened participation (13th, 14th, 15th, 19th, 24th, 26th)	Week 15
SS.7.CG.3.7	Structure, functions, processes of the legislative branch	Week 9
SS.7.CG.3.8	Structure, functions, processes of the executive branch	Week 10
SS.7.CG.3.9	Structure, functions, processes of the judicial branch	Week 11

SS.7.CG.3.10	Sources and types of law	Module 6, Gap-Fill 10 (standalone)
SS.7.CG.3.11	Effects of landmark Supreme Court decisions	Weeks 13–15
SS.7.CG.3.12	Comparing the U.S. and Florida constitutions (<i>enrichment only in Q1; formally assessed on the Q2 Exam</i>)	Extension, Week 6
SS.7.CG.3.13	Government services at local/state/national levels (<i>enrichment only in Q1; formally assessed on the Q2 Exam</i>)	Extension, Week 6
SS.7.CG.3.14	Purpose and function of the Electoral College (<i>enrichment only in Q1; formally assessed on the Q2 Exam</i>)	Extension, Week 8
SS.7.CG.3.15	Advantages of capitalism/free markets over government-controlled systems	Week 18

REPORTING CATEGORY 4: ORGANIZATION AND FUNCTION OF GOVERNMENT (3 EOC-TESTED BENCHMARKS; SS.7.CG.4.4 EXCLUDED, NOT EOC-TESTED)

Benchmark	What it covers	Where taught
SS.7.CG.4.1	Relationship between U.S. foreign and domestic policy	Week 17
SS.7.CG.4.2	U.S. and citizen participation in international organizations	Week 17
SS.7.CG.4.3	U.S. actions and reactions in international conflicts	Week 17
SS.7.CG.4.4 (<i>not EOC-tested</i>)	The U.S. and the wider world (response to attack)	Module 6, Gap-Fill 14 (standalone)

Using this index before the real EOC: after each Quarterly Exam, pull the item analysis and group missed questions by Reporting Category using the tables above. A cohort-wide miss on a Category 3 item, for example, tells you to spend a review day on that specific benchmark before students sit the actual state EOC. The four (*enrichment only in Q1*) rows are worth a second look regardless of exam performance — they get only an Extension-level reading during the quarter they're taught in, not a full week, so confirm with a quick check whether your cohort needs more than the Q2 Exam alone gives them.

Full per-source detail, including which Extension or Gap-Fill teaches each benchmark and the reverse week-by-week index, lives in the appendix Standards Crosswalk of the print course build ([03_Build/fragments/appendix/01-standards-crosswalk.html](#)) if you need it at a level of detail beyond this summary.

SECTION

12 What makes this course classical & cultivating culture

Classical moves this course actually makes:

- **Primary sources, every week.** Students meet Aristotle, Cicero, Locke, Jefferson, Madison, and the Constitution itself — not a textbook summary of them. The Great Conversation is the method, not a slogan.

- **Argue from the text.** The Critical Questions are built to reward reasoning from evidence and to defeat mere restating — a Notice–Name–Apply pattern applied to founding documents.
- **A single, human throughline.** The whole year answers one question — what it takes for people to govern themselves — from Athens to the present.
- **The virtue thread.** Self-government is both an Optima virtue and the literal subject of the course; the wrappers ask students to reflect on it.

Cultivating culture in an asynchronous course: name students' good thinking in feedback and (with permission) in announcements; write announcements that model your own curiosity about the sources; keep the year's question visible; treat feedback as a relationship, not a transaction. In VR and study hall, let students hear each other reason aloud — that is where an async cohort becomes a community.

SECTION

13 Sensitive-content flags & family/student scripts

Flag these in advance. Give a neutral setup; save any debate for the lesson.

Where	What
Module 4, Lessons 13–15	Landmark cases involve religion, criminal interrogation and policing (Miranda, Terry), and racial segregation (Plessy, Brown), including period language and reasoning students may find upsetting.
Module 5, Lesson 18	The Soviet famine (Gareth Jones) and the Gulag (Solzhenitsyn): starvation, forced labor, and state repression, presented to contrast life with and without liberty.
Module 2, Lesson 7	The Sicilian Expedition (Thucydides): war and catastrophic loss, used as a warning about democratic overreach.

Advance script (edit and send). “Dear families, in the coming weeks our class reads primary sources that deal with [segregation and landmark civil-rights cases / repression under the Soviet system / the costs of war]. We approach them soberly and historically, because understanding how liberty is won and lost is central to civics. If you'd like to talk through the material or have questions, please reach out — [name], [email], office hours [day/time].”

SECTION

14 Running this course live, four days a week

The course is written asynchronously; a live section uses the same content, unchanged, but spreads one numbered lesson across four class meetings. The rhythm below turns each week's async components into live work. It holds for a standard one-lesson week (Modules 1, 4, 5); for the six-week Module 2 and three-week Module 3, keep the same four-day shape and simply run one numbered lesson per week.

Day	Async component it draws on	What the class does live (4 days)
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Day 1 — Launch	Lesson X.1 page + Quick Check-In; Intro Wrapper (module start)	Open with the framing question as a quick poll. Teach Part 1–2 of the lesson together and model a close read of the first primary source's opening lines. Assign the Reading Quiz as homework or an exit ticket.
Day 2 — Source seminar	Primary Source 1 + Critical Questions X.1	Read and annotate the source as a group. Use the Critical Questions as the discussion spine — students argue positions aloud before writing. End by having them draft one answer in class.
Day 3 — Deepen + VR	Lesson X.2 + Primary Source 2; VR X-A / X-B	Teach the second half, then run the week's VR activity as a shared session (everyone in the same space, then a short gallery walk of captures). For structure/case modules, this is the “how it works” day.
Day 4 — Write & assess	Primary Source Report / Exercise X; Extension (Weeks 5–11); Outro Wrapper (module end)	Students draft the Primary Source Report in class with you circulating — the highest-value use of live time. Confirm the Reading Quiz is done. On the last day of a module, close with the Outro Wrapper. Administer the Quarterly Exam as a normal in-class sitting on the day it falls in your pacing (right after Week 9 for Quarter 1, end of Module 5 for Quarter 2).

Turning solo VR into a shared session: keep the same task, but have students compare choices afterward (“why did you stand where you stood?”). The gallery walk replaces the async capture-review. The Reading Quiz works well as a live warm-up (Day 2) or exit ticket (Day 1) — same auto-grading; it now also tells you what to reteach before Day 2's seminar. Pacing: one numbered lesson = one four-day week. Module 2 is six such weeks; Module 3 is three. Fold the extension assignments into Day 4 or assign as homework in the heavier modules. Grading load is lighter live than On-Demand at the same moment, because much of the writing happens in class where you coach it in real time — but the same rubric (§6) still applies. If you want the Quarterly Exams weighted differently than the course's 30% default for your Live section, that's a per-section gradebook adjustment, not a change to the shared course setup — see §5.

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